VS-07 Governance and Compliance

Table of contents

VS-07 Governance and Compliance . . . 1
1. Purpose and value created . . . 1
2. Relation to the value chain . . . 1
3. Stages . . . 2
4. Plan, build, operate, and improve . . . 5
5. Actors and roles . . . 6
6. Capabilities, processes, and functions . . . 7
7. Principles . . . 8
8. Interfaces, services, and events . . . 9
9. Key performance indicators . . . 10
10. Examples . . . 11

VS-07 Governance and Compliance

1. Purpose and value created

VS-07 makes sure that every process, dataset, and product of the NSI operates under clear rules, standards, and accountability. It builds trust, inside and outside the NSI, by making sure that all data activities are ethical, transparent, and compliant with legal, methodological, and quality requirements. It aligns the NSI with standards such as the European Statistics Code of Practice, GDPR, GSBPM, GAMSO, and the ISO data quality principles. The value created is **integrity and accountability**: the NSI acts responsibly, protects privacy, and delivers products that users can trust.

VS-07 does not move data along the chain. It oversees the value streams that do. It sets the rules they must follow, collects the evidence that they follow them, and provides assurance to management, supervisory bodies, and society. VS-07 is the place where the data principles SAF-P09, SAF-P10, and SAF-P11 are enforced across the whole NSI. This section covers the governance capabilities, how they are established and operated, and how they interact with the rest of the value chain. The application and technology controls that implement them are provided with VS-09.

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view VS-07 (a) value stream and capabilities

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2. Relation to the value chain

VS-07 is not a stage in the production line. It runs horizontally and continuously across all value streams, primary and supporting. It interacts with them in two directions. Downward, it imposes governance frameworks, policies, roles, and controls. Upward, it receives compliance evidence, quality indicators, and audit findings. The *Audit and Compliance Reporting* sub-process of each primary value stream (see Standard activities in every value stream) feeds directly into VS-07. Outward, VS-07 issues certification and assurance to regulators, the public, and international peers.

Primary value stream(s)	Provides	Receives
VS-01 to VS-06	Governance frameworks and policies, legal register and compliance procedures, data governance role assignments, metadata and lineage rules, controls	Compliance evidence, quality indicators, audit trails, and audit findings from each stream's *Audit and Compliance Reporting*

VS-07 maps to the GAMSO areas **Strategy and Leadership** and **Corporate Support**, and to Capability Management for the life cycle of standards, methods, and data assets (see *Framework mappings*). VS-07 has no state transition and no registration event. Its output is an enabling capability: governance frameworks, compliance mechanisms, assurance, and audit results.

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view VS-07 (c) interactions with the value chain: VS-07 sets frameworks, policies, roles, and controls for all value streams (VS-01 to VS-10); the streams return compliance evidence, quality indicators, and audit findings; VS-07 provides certification and assurance to regulators, the public, and international peers

3. Stages

The stages form a continuous governance loop. VS-07.1 and VS-07.2 set the rules, VS-07.3 embeds them in the work of the value streams, VS-07.4 and VS-07.5 assure that they are followed, and VS-07.6 keeps them up to date. The loop never stops running.

Stage	Name	Value added
VS-07.1	Define Governance Frameworks and Policies	Rules for data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality, and quality are set
VS-07.2	Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms	Applicable rules are known and translated into procedures
VS-07.3	Implement Data and Metadata Governance	Ownership, stewardship, and lineage are assigned
VS-07.4	Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators	Quality and compliance status is visible
VS-07.5	Audit, Certify and Report Compliance	Compliance is demonstrated
VS-07.6	Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms	Governance keeps up with new rules and lessons learned

VS-07.1 Define Governance Frameworks and Policies

Value created: *A clear rule book that the whole organisation works under.*

This stage defines the overarching charters and principles that cover data, metadata, ethics, confidentiality, and statistical quality. Together they form the rule book of the NSI. The chief data officer sets the data policy and the governance framework, with the data governance board (COL-06). The quality manager sets the quality framework. Controls are aligned with organisational value and accountability, so that governance does not exist for its own sake (SAF-P04).

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Define the governance charter and accountability structure	Governance charter	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets	4.1.1 Strategy and governance; GAMSO Strategy and Leadership

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Define the data and metadata policies, including classification obligations	Data policy, metadata policy	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets; OVA-2 Metadata Management	SAF-P09; 2.1.1 Data lifecycle management
Define the ethics and confidentiality policy, including disclosure control	Confidentiality policy	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	SAF-P11; 3.3.1 Privacy management
Define the quality framework: dimensions, indicators, reporting requirements	Quality framework	OVA-1 Quality Management	2.1.3 Statistical quality management; European Statistics Code of Practice
Define the steady-state interface and event conventions that all streams follow	Interface and event conventions	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets	SAF-P07

VS-07.2 Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms

Value created: *Every process stays within the law, and the NSI knows which rules apply.*

This stage identifies the regulations that apply to the NSI: GDPR, official statistics legislation, and data sharing agreements. Legal counsel interprets them, and the compliance officer translates them into procedures that keep every process within the law. The applicable provisions are kept in a legal register. The stage also sets the information security and access control framework (SAF-P10) and the privacy policy (SAF-P11) that the value streams and VS-09 must apply.

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Identify the applicable regulations: GDPR, statistics law, data sharing agreements	Legal register	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	3.1.7 Legal support
Interpret regulation and frame compliance procedures	Compliance procedures mapped to regulation	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	3.1.7 Legal support
Set the information security and access control framework	Security policy	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	SAF-P10; 3.3.2 Security planning; 3.3.4 Logical identity and access control
Set the privacy policy, including purpose limitation and data minimisation	Privacy policy	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	SAF-P11; 3.3.1 Privacy management; GDPR
Define the compliance criteria that new processes and methods must meet before production	Compliance criteria	OVA-1 Quality Management	SAF-P03

VS-07.3 Implement Data and Metadata Governance

Value created: *Governance is wired into how the streams actually work, not only on paper.*

This stage makes the frameworks operational. The chief data officer assigns the data governance roles (data owner, data steward, data custodian) to people and units in every data domain. The processes for metadata creation, maintenance, and lineage tracking are put in place, so that each value stream captures metadata

at the point each value is created or changed (SAF-P09). Access rules follow from the role assignments. The supporting tooling, such as catalogue functions and dashboards, is built with VS-09.

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Assign data owner, data steward, and data custodian roles per data domain	Data governance role assignments	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets; OVA-3 Data Management	2.1.1 Data lifecycle management
Set up the processes for metadata creation and maintenance	Metadata rules	OVA-2 Metadata Management	SAF-P09; 2.1.2 Metadata management
Set up lineage tracking rules across the steady states	Lineage rules	OVA-2 Metadata Management; OVA-3 Data Management	SAF-P09
Set the access rules that follow from the role assignments	Access rules	DLM-6 Provide data for reuse	SAF-P10
Build governance tooling and dashboards with VS-09	Governance tooling, dashboards	OVA-3 Data Management	3.2.2 Functional management

VS-07.4 Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators

Value created: *Quality and compliance status is visible at any time.*

With the controls in place, VS-07 measures process and output quality, such as accuracy, timeliness, and comparability. It tracks compliance status on formal scorecards and dashboards. The input is the compliance evidence and the quality indicators that the value streams report. Monitoring also covers the use of microdata by researchers and the NSI's own exchanges in data spaces. Metadata governance compliance is checked from the evidence of the streams: the share of registered datasets that meet the SAF-P09 obligations.

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Measure process and output quality: accuracy, timeliness, comparability	Quality scorecard	OVA-1 Quality Management	2.1.3 Statistical quality management
Consolidate the compliance evidence of all value streams	Compliance dashboard	OVA-1 Quality Management; DLM-8 Monitor data quality, lineage and use	4.1.5 Accountability
Monitor metadata and lineage compliance of registered datasets	Metadata governance compliance report	DLM-8 Monitor data quality, lineage and use	SAF-P09
Monitor compliance with the conditions of microdata use	Microdata compliance report	MDS-8 Monitor use and compliance	SAF-P11
Monitor compliance of data space exchanges	Data space compliance report	DSP-5 Monitor compliance and report	

VS-07.5 Audit, Certify and Report Compliance

Value created: *Demonstrated assurance that the statistics can be trusted.*

Periodically, VS-07 conducts internal and external audits, performs quality reviews, and documents adherence to the frameworks. Auditors review evidence such as logs, quality reports, and lineage records. The quality manager prepares the NSI for peer reviews against the European Statistics Code of Practice. The

results are audit reports, certifications, and assurance statements for management, supervisory authorities, and the public. Transparency reports meet the accountability commitments to stakeholders.

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Conduct internal and external audits of processes and controls	Audit reports, audit findings	OVA-1 Quality Management; PRD-8.2 Conduct evaluation	4.1.5 Accountability
Perform quality reviews and peer reviews	Quality review reports	PRD-8.2 Conduct evaluation	European Statistics Code of Practice
Obtain and maintain certifications	Certifications	OVA-1 Quality Management	ISO data quality principles
Document adherence and issue assurance statements	Assurance statements	OVA-1 Quality Management	4.1.5 Accountability
Publish transparency reports	Transparency report	OVA-1 Quality Management	4.1.5 Accountability

VS-07.6 Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms

Value created: *Governance evolves with the organisation instead of becoming rigid.*

This stage closes the loop. It incorporates feedback, regulatory changes, and lessons learned from audits into the policies and control frameworks. Each policy and control is version-managed across its life cycle (SAF-P03): changes are tracked, prior versions remain identifiable, and obsolete policies and controls are formally retired. Changes to retention, archiving, and disposal rules are passed to the value streams that apply them.

Activity	Key outputs	SAF process	Other reference
Analyse feedback, audit findings, and regulatory changes	Policy change proposals	PRD-8.3 Agree an action plan	4.1.4 Improvement management
Revise policies and controls, and track remediation of audit findings	Revised policies and controls	PRD-8.3 Agree an action plan	4.1.2 Policy and planning
Version policies and formally retire obsolete ones	Policy version history	PRD-8.3 Agree an action plan	SAF-P03
Update retention, archiving, and disposal rules	Revised retention rules	DLM-10 Archive and preserve data; DLM-11 Dispose of data	SAF-P03

4. Plan, build, operate, and improve

VS-07 is itself a capability that must be planned (its frameworks and operating model), built (roles, tooling, and dashboards, with VS-09), operated (continuous monitoring and periodic audit), and improved. Unlike a primary value stream, it runs continuously and organisation-wide, not as a production run per cycle, and it produces assurance rather than statistical data.

Cycle step	What happens in VS-07	Main outputs	SAF process
Plan	Define the governance frameworks and policies (VS-07.1) and the legal and regulatory compliance mechanisms (VS-07.2)	Governance charter, policies, legal register, compliance procedures	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets; DLM-4 Classify and protect data; OVA-1 Quality Management
Build	Implement data and metadata governance (VS-07.3): assign roles, set up metadata and lineage processes, build tooling and dashboards with VS-09	Role assignments, metadata and lineage rules, governance tooling	OVA-2 Metadata Management; OVA-3 Data Management; DLM-6 Provide data for reuse
Operate	Monitor quality and compliance indicators continuously (VS-07.4); audit, certify, and report periodically (VS-07.5)	Dashboards, scorecards, audit reports, certifications, assurance statements	OVA-1 Quality Management; DLM-8 Monitor data quality, lineage and use; MDS-8 Monitor use and compliance; DSP-5 Monitor compliance and report; PRD-8.2 Conduct evaluation
Improve	Update and improve the governance mechanisms (VS-07.6)	Revised policies and controls	PRD-8.3 Agree an action plan; DLM-10 Archive and preserve data; DLM-11 Dispose of data

Governance artefacts. VS-07 manages enabling artefacts, not data states: the governance framework and policy set, the regulatory compliance register, the data governance role assignments with the metadata and lineage rules, the quality and compliance dashboards, and the audit and certification reports. Every value stream refers to them. Each artefact has a designated owner and is version-managed across its life cycle (SAF-P03).

VS-07 monitors itself with the same discipline it imposes on the chain (attribute 9).

5. Actors and roles

VS-07 defines and assigns the data governance roles for the whole NSI, and it relies on the assurance roles. Specialised role names map onto the reference roles (see *Role names in the value streams*): the Chief Data / Governance Officer is ROL-05 Chief data officer, Legal Counsel is a form of ROL-19 Compliance officer, and the Internal / External Auditor is ROL-21 Auditor. Data policy across domains is steered by the collaboration COL-06 *Data governance board*.

Actor or role	ID	Process type	Responsibility in VS-07
Supervisory and legal authority	ACT-08	External	Sets regulatory requirements and changes; assesses compliance; receives certification and assurance
International statistical organisation	ACT-07	External	Sets standards; takes part in peer reviews, for example against the Code of Practice

Actor or role	ID	Process type	Responsibility in VS-07
Chief data officer	ROL-05	Plan, Build	Accountable for the governance framework and organisational data policy; assigns the data governance roles
Compliance officer (incl. legal counsel)	ROL-19	Plan, Operate	Ensures legal and regulatory compliance (Code of Practice, GDPR, statistics law); interprets regulation and frames compliance procedures; keeps the legal register
Data owner, data steward, data custodian	ROL-02, ROL-03, ROL-04	Build, Operate	The data governance roles that VS-07 defines and assigns across domains
Quality manager	ROL-18	Plan, Operate	Defines quality indicators and monitors quality and compliance status
Security officer	ROL-20	Plan, Operate	Defines the security and continuity policy that VS-09 enforces; reviews security posture and incidents
Auditor (internal or external)	ROL-21	Operate	Conducts audits and certifications of adherence to the frameworks
Process owners (VS-01 to VS-10)	ROL-01	Operate	Accountable, in their own streams, for operating within the controls of VS-07 and supplying evidence

6. Capabilities, processes, and functions

Capability foundations

Capability group	Capabilities	Role in VS-07
4.1 Strategy and leadership	4.1.1 Strategy and governance, 4.1.2 Policy and planning, 4.1.4 Improvement management, 4.1.5 Accountability	Set governance strategy and accountability, translate it into policies, improve governance, report on compliance
2.1 Data management	2.1.1 Data lifecycle management, 2.1.2 Metadata management, 2.1.3 Statistical quality management	Govern the life cycle of data assets, metadata, and quality across the chain
3.1 Business operations	3.1.7 Legal support	Interpret regulation and assess agreements
3.3 Security and privacy	3.3.1 Privacy management, 3.3.2 Security planning, 3.3.3 Security incident management	Set and assure the privacy and information security framework

Stages, processes, and functions

Stage	Realised by processes	Main functions
VS-07.1 Define Governance Frameworks and Policies	DLM-1 Plan and design data assets	FUN-1.2 Govern and steer the organisation; FUN-5.1 Manage the quality framework; FUN-7.1 Govern data
VS-07.2 Establish Legal and Regulatory Compliance Mechanisms	DLM-4 Classify and protect data	FUN-10.5 Manage legal affairs; FUN-10.8 Manage information security and privacy
VS-07.3 Implement Data and Metadata Governance	OVA-2 Metadata Management; OVA-3 Data Management; DLM-1 Plan and design data assets; DLM-6 Provide data for reuse	FUN-7.1 Govern data; FUN-7.2 Manage metadata
VS-07.4 Monitor Quality and Compliance Indicators	OVA-1 Quality Management; DLM-8 Monitor data quality, lineage and use; MDS-8 Monitor use and compliance; DSP-5 Monitor compliance and report	FUN-5.2 Assure and review quality; FUN-7.1 Govern data
VS-07.5 Audit, Certify and Report Compliance	OVA-1 Quality Management; PRD-8.2 Conduct evaluation	FUN-1.2 Govern and steer the organisation; FUN-5.2 Assure and review quality
VS-07.6 Update and Improve Governance Mechanisms	PRD-8.3 Agree an action plan; DLM-10 Archive and preserve data; DLM-11 Dispose of data	FUN-2.1 Plan capability improvements; FUN-7.1 Govern data

PLACEHOLDER: ArchiMate view VS-07 (b) stages realised by processes and functions

Framework mappings

Where the primary value streams map to GSBPM production phases, VS-07 maps to the GAMSO overarching activities.

GAMSO area	Relevance to VS-07	Stages
Strategy and Leadership	Set governance strategy, charters, and accountability; manage organisational and ethical frameworks	VS-07.1, VS-07.5
Corporate Support	Manage the legal framework, quality management, and information security governance	VS-07.2, VS-07.4, VS-07.5
Capability Management	Govern the life cycle of standards, methods, and data assets	VS-07.3, VS-07.6

External standards that VS-07 aligns the NSI with: European Statistics Code of Practice, GDPR, GSBPM, GAMSO, and the ISO data quality principles.

7. Principles

VS-07 foregrounds SAF-P03 and SAF-P04, and it enforces the data principles SAF-P09, SAF-P10, and SAF-P11 across the whole chain.

Principle	Statement	Application in VS-07
SAF-P09	No data without metadata and classification	Governs metadata and classification obligations and audits them across every value stream
SAF-P10	Security By Design	Sets and assures the information security and access control framework
SAF-P11	Privacy By Design	Sets the privacy, confidentiality, and disclosure control policy and verifies compliance
SAF-P03	Active Life Cycle management	Governs the life cycle of policies, standards, classifications, and data assets; versions governance artefacts and retires obsolete ones
SAF-P04	Maximise the benefits for the organisation	Aligns controls to organisational value and accountability, avoiding governance for its own sake
SAF-P07	Implement loosely coupled processes and systems	Defines the steady-state interface and event conventions that the value streams are governed by

8. Interfaces, services, and events

Business services

VS-07 offers governance and assurance as a service to every other value stream.

Service	Offered to	Realised in	Interfaces
Governance framework and policy service	All value streams	VS-07.1, VS-07.2, VS-07.3	Policy set, legal register, role assignments, metadata and lineage rules
Compliance assessment service	VS-08, process owners	VS-07.2	Compliance criteria; assessment of new methods and processes before production
Quality and compliance monitoring service	Management, process owners	VS-07.4	Dashboards and scorecards
Audit and certification service	Management, supervisory authorities, the public, international peers	VS-07.5	Audit reports, certifications, assurance statements, transparency reports

Business events

Event	Triggers or marks
Regulatory change	Review of the legal register and policies in VS-07.2 and VS-07.6
Policy update issued	The value streams adapt their designs and controls
Compliance review	Periodic review of a stream's compliance evidence in VS-07.4
Method compliance assessment	Request from VS-08 to assess a new method before production

Event	Triggers or marks
Security/continuity review	Review of the security posture and incident evidence of VS-09
Audit	Start of an internal or external audit in VS-07.5
Certification	Outcome of VS-07.5 towards external parties
Transparency report	Publication of accountability information, also used by VS-10

Interaction with the primary value streams

Each primary value stream supplies the evidence for the audit focus of the state it produces (see *Producing and consuming domains* in each state of the Steady-State Architecture).

Value stream	Provides to VS-07	Audit focus of VS-07
VS-01 Data Acquisition and Ingestion	Audit trails, records of processing, agreement compliance	Provenance and legal basis (State #1)
VS-02 Data Standardization and Integration	Mapping lineage, privacy and standards compliance	Mapping lineage and pseudonymisation (State #2)
VS-03 Data Editing and Enrichment	Edit audit, disclosure risk and methodology compliance	Edit lineage, methodology compliance, disclosure risk (State #3)
VS-04 Estimation, Analysis and Statistical Modeling	Reproducibility audit, disclosure control reporting	Methodology, reproducibility, approval (State #4)
VS-05 Statistical Product Composition	Approval and confidentiality reporting	Methodology, reproducibility, approval (State #4 approved)
VS-06 Dissemination and Service Delivery	Disclosure, equal access, and accessibility compliance	Disclosure control, equal access, release authorisation (State #5)

Interaction with the other supporting value streams and external parties

Counterpart	VS-07 provides	VS-07 receives
VS-08 Innovation and Methodological Development	Compliance criteria a new method must meet	Requests to assess and approve new methods before production
VS-09 Infrastructure and Platform Enablement	Security and continuity policy to enforce	Security posture and incident evidence
VS-10 Customer and Stakeholder Engagement	Transparency and accountability commitments	Stakeholder trust signals and complaints
Regulators, the public, international peers	Certification, assurance, transparency reports	Regulatory requirements and changes

9. Key performance indicators

KPI	Description	Measurement
Policy coverage	Share of value streams and data domains operating under current, approved policies	Per policy domain, annually
Audit findings closed on time	Percentage of audit findings remediated within their agreed deadline	Per audit cycle
Compliance incidents	Number of confidentiality, security, or legal incidents	Per quarter (target: zero)

KPI	Description	Measurement
Certification status	Certifications and peer review assessments held and current (for example the Code of Practice)	Annually
Metadata governance compliance	Share of registered datasets meeting the SAF-P09 obligations	Per cycle, from the streams' *Audit and Compliance Reporting*
Regulatory response time	Time from detection of a regulatory change to an updated policy being issued	Per change

10. Examples

Regulatory change. A change in data protection law is detected. Legal counsel interprets it, and the compliance officer updates the legal register and the privacy policy. The *Policy update issued* event reaches the process owners, who adapt their designs and controls. The regulatory response time KPI measures the time from detection to the updated policy.

Peer review. The quality manager prepares the NSI for a peer review against the European Statistics Code of Practice. The evidence comes from the dashboards of VS-07.4 and from the *Audit and Compliance Reporting* of each primary value stream. The findings are tracked to closure in VS-07.6.

Toolkit: SAF-TK-V07 VS-07 maturity checklist and scenarios